

FieldShift Complete Game Manual
Support email: jjshep42ac@gmail.com

Introduction

FieldShift at its core is a game of wits. It is a game of intuitive thinking and of shrewd decisions, of remaining sharp under pressure. Yet it is all of these things in tandem that comprise the game's core element. Any experienced FieldShift player will opt not to describe the game as a game of wits, intuition, or focus, but as one of strategy. To succeed in FieldShift is to best your opponent in the full utilization of the mind. That is to say, even a particularly shrewd player can be overcome by a nobody if the nobody is merely thinking hard enough to overcome the opponent's wit. With this in mind, victory will show itself before you – you need only grasp it. Now, arm yourself with the knowledge contained below and set forth onto the field. And remember - there is no such thing as luck in FieldShift.

Board Control Tool

The FieldShift Board Control Tool (FS BoardCT) is a software tool that takes each player's command as input and modifies the board accordingly, displaying the updated information. The tool is written in Python with cross-platform consideration, and thus runs on Linux systems and Windows 10/11 machines. It is available at <https://github.com/JJ-Shep/fieldshift-boardct>

Command Issuance Standards

Actions in FieldShift are conducted through the turn-based issuance of commands. The default ruleset by which commands are issued is called the LSTD, an abbreviation of "launch standard". A command per the LSTD ruleset consists of two digits, called arguments. The initial digit is used for the instruction, an action to take. The final digit specifies the target of the action. This system was chosen for its adherence to the following principles:

1. Brevity - Commands are concise and efficient
2. Security - Commands are unintelligible to laymen
3. Integrity - Commands are clear, solid, and unmistakable

The table of instructions below details each initial digit and the corresponding instruction. These will be explained later. Instruction 1 is different when using an alternative ruleset.

#	Instruction
0	AUX
1	SWC/SWP
2	MOV
3	HIT
4	RNF
5	WDR
6	RGP
7	OVW
8	SKL
9	SPT

Auxiliary Instruction

Each instruction is important, and none are without their uses. However, the AUX (Auxiliary) instruction is unique. It is largely unimportant for gameplay, but is used for supplementary functions. The AUX table, shown below, defines the meaning of each digit when used as an argument for the AUX instruction.

AUX Table

#	Definition
0	Deny
1	Confirm
2	Suspend game
3	Resume suspended game
4	Initiate game [deprecated]
5	Request change ruleset
6	Dispute
7	Good game
8	Request draw
9	Concede

Auxiliary Processes

A player can suspend a game with 02. FS BoardCT will then write a list of instructions to the file. The 03 instruction will prompt the user for the path to a suspended game file.

At any time, a player may request a change to the STDEX ruleset with the 05 command. The other player may then confirm or deny the request. After changing the ruleset, any player may request a change to STDEX Type-A with 05.

The dispute mechanic activated by the 06 command can be invoked by a player who observes a rule violation from their opponent. If the disputed player has in fact violated the rules, the official FS BoardCT will end the game as a loss for the player who made a rule violation. The opportunity to dispute a rule violation expires on the offender's next turn, so a dispute must be done immediately after the rule violation occurs. Additionally, attempting to dispute when a rule violation has not occurred will end the disputing player's turn. Thus, it is advised only to dispute when you are sure that a rule has been broken.

The 08 command allows a player to request a draw, and prompts the other player for their response.

A player can concede with the 09 command, after which the game immediately ends with their loss.

Operators

The units controlled in FieldShift are known as operators. Each player has two of each class. Operators 0-4 are on the field at the beginning of the game. Operators 5-9 are in reserve, and can be brought out via the RGP (regroup) instruction. All five of player 1's operators will start on sector 0. All five of player 2's operators will start on sector 9. In the LSTD ruleset, operator 0 is the operator selected at the beginning of the game.

If an operator is below full vitality, BoardCT will display a 'v' followed by their remaining vitality after the operator's number. If an operator's vitality reaches zero, the operator begins bleeding out for five turns. BoardCT will display this as an 'X' followed by the remaining turns before death appended to the operator's number. A game is won if the enemy has no operators with at least 1 vitality deployed on the field.

Operators can belong to a small variety of classes, each with different statistics and properties. The class statistics in the LSTD are as follows:

Class statistic table

Class	Vitality	Attack	Range
Sniper	5	3	5
Blade			0
Technician			3
Medic			3
Specialist			3

Alternative Rulesets

In addition to the LSTD, there exist one-and-a-half more rulesets. The STDEX, from "extended standard", introduces an additional digit in between the initial and final digits. As a result, the target of the instruction becomes the third digit. The second digit now provides additional information whose purpose changes based on the instruction.

The most common application of this is in commands that order the selected operator to conduct an action. By using the second digit for the operator conducting the action, the slow process of switching the selected operator becomes unnecessary. For example, attacking hostile operator 5 with friendly operator 2 would require two commands in the LSTD: One to select operator 2, and another to attack operator 5 with the selected operator. In the STDEX, this can be done with one command. These commands have not been listed, as the manual section on the next page (Instruction Details) will explain command instructions. However as a proof of concept, the LSTD command sequence for the above example is [12, 35]. The STDEX command would be [325].

There is additionally a modified variant of this ruleset, STDEX Type-A. However, its only difference from the STDEX is adjusting stats to make the optimal move less optimal.

Instruction Details

For any instruction referring to "a friendly operator", the operator must be the selected operator if the LSTD ruleset is in place.

- SWC - Switch: Change the currently selected operator. Does not end turn.
- SWP - Swap: Swap the sectors of two friendly operators.
- MOV - Move: Move a friendly operator to a sector.
- HIT - Hit: Attack an enemy operator in range. Argument number directly corresponds to enemy unit number.
- RNF - Reinforce: Add 1 supply crate to a facility, the STDEX extra argument allows the player to specify the number of crates allocated.
- WDR - Withdraw: Take 1 supply crate from a facility. Does not end turn. The STDEX extra argument allows the player to specify the number of crates allocated.
- RGP - Regroup: When called with the number of a deployed operator, retreat the operator from the battle and gain 1 supply crate (legal in all circumstances). When called with the number of a reserve operator, deploy that operator to the battle and lose 1 supply crate (illegal if supply crate balance is zero).
- OVW - Overwatch: Give a specified operator overwatch status: The next time an enemy operator moves in or out of attack range, land a free attack on the enemy operator. Expires on the next friendly turn.
- SKL - Skill: When called with the number of a deployed operator, activate that operator's class skill. Cooldown affects all friendly operators and lasts five friendly turns. Skill is on cooldown at the beginning of the game.
- SPT - Support: When called with the number of a facility, activate that facility's support skill. Cooldown affects all friendly facilities and lasts five friendly turns. Support is on cooldown at the beginning of the game.

Supply crates

Each player begins with one supply crate. Killing an enemy operator or retreating a friendly operator grants one supply crate. Supply crates can be used to deploy an operator from reserve or can be allocated to facilities.

Terrain

There are four types of terrain in FieldShift, and ten sectors of the battlefield. Sectors 0 and 9 are ruins, which protect operators at their immediate deployment location. Sectors 1 and 8 are tall grass, which serves as a line of defense outside of the ruins on either side. Sectors 2-3 and 6-7 are plains, where most combat is intended to be done. Sectors 4-5 are mountains, a high-risk high-reward terrain in the center of the battlefield. The table of terrain properties is detailed below.

Terrain	Properties
Ruins	Cover: -1 damage taken Visual obstruction: -2 to range of incoming and outgoing attacks
Tall grass	Concealment: -1 to range of incoming attacks
Mountains	High ground: +1 to damage dealt Out in the open: +1 to damage taken
Plains	N/A

Operator Skills

Each operator class is associated with a skill, all of which are considerably effective if used correctly. BoardCT will display an active skill as an 'S' appended to the operator's number. This 'S' will be followed by the number of remaining turns for skills that end after a set number of turns. If an operator is retreated while their skill is active, the skill will be canceled. The skills for each class are detailed as follows.

Sniper: One shot, one kill - Takes a guaranteed kill shot with no range limit on the next hostile operator that moves.

Blade: Assassinate - The blade's next attack deals guaranteed lethal damage and executes a free MOV to the target's sector that cannot trigger overwatch. Initial skill activation does not end turn. Skill activation immediately triggers attack in STDEX, where the third argument specifies the target.

Technician: Cyberwarfare - Prevents the opponent from executing a SKL, SPT, or RGP for the next three hostile turns. Ends early if the technician is eliminated.

Medic: Extend - LSTD: Does not end turn. The next time the HIT instruction is activated, the argument specifies a friendly operator that is bleeding out. The specified operator is then revived and restored to 5 vitality. STDEX: Immediately triggers revive when skill is activated, where the third argument specifies the revive target.

Specialist: Quick draw - The specialist's next three HITs do not end the turn. Activating this skill also does not end the turn.

Support facilities

Each player has access to several support facilities located on the tile their operators start on. Support facilities start with zero supplies. Using the RNF instruction to allocate supply crates to a facility will increase its operating capability for each allocated crate. The facilities are as follows:

- Artillery: Facility 0. Support skill readies the artillery and cancels the cooldown for the SPT instruction. The next time the SPT instruction is used, the argument will be interpreted as a sector number rather than a facility number, and the artillery will deal one point of damage to every hostile unit in that sector. The damage amount is increased by one for each allocated supply crate.
- Medbay: Facility 1. Passively restores the vitality of all injured reserve operators by one every 4 turns. The healing cooldown is decreased by one for each allocated supply crate. Once enough supply crates are allocated to decrease the cooldown to one turn, further allocated crates will instead increase the amount healed. Support skill restores the health of all deployed but injured operators by two.
- Command center: Facility 2. Decreases the cooldown for the SPT instruction by one turn for each allocated supply crate. Support skill swaps the reserve status of all friendly operators

Quick Reference Sheet

Instructions		Auxiliary		Terrain Types	
0	AUX	0	Deny	0	Ruins
1	SWC/SWP	1	Confirm	1	Tall Grass
2	MOV	2	Suspend game	2	Plains
3	HIT	3	Resume suspended game	3	
4	RNF	4	Initiate contact	4	Mountain
5	WDR	5	Request change ruleset	5	
6	RGP	6	Dispute	6	Plains
7	OVW	7	Good game	7	
8	SKL	8	Request draw	8	Tall Grass
9	SPT	9	Concede	9	Ruins

Operators

Class	#		Vitality	Attack	Atk. (Type-A)	Range	Rng. (Type-A)
Sniper	0	5	5	3	2	5	5
Blade	1	6				0	0
Technician	2	7				3	2
Medic	3	8				3	2
Specialist	4	9				3	2

Facility numbers

#	0	1	2
Facility	Artillery	Medbay	Command Center